

School: Acle St Edmunds

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Report: End of year progress report and next steps

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Introduction and approach

The report is written from information obtained from the DPE dashboard, onsite visits, remote consultations and previous audit walks. The report content is divided into 5 sections:

1. Leadership and oversight
2. Policies and procedures
3. Training and awareness
4. Audit walk findings
5. Next steps

1. Leadership and oversight

The school buys into the Data Protection Education (DPE) service as the schools named DPO and has access to the DPE knowledge bank; including the school dashboard; best practice areas and compliance documents. Resources also include e-learning training and there is a breach, FOI and SAR log. The school's business manager (NB) oversees GDPR compliance and liaises directly with DPE for the school's GDPR compliance programme. The school has a proactive approach to GDPR compliance and is in the process of appointing a new governor assigned for data protection, after having previously had this in place.

2. Policies and procedures

There is a dedicated GDPR section on the school website with the following DPE GDPR documentation listed:

- GDPR policy
- Privacy Notice for pupils and general public (i.e. visitors)
- Supplier third party list
- Consent guidance and withdrawal form
- Freedom of information publication scheme

Compliance documents will be reviewed by DPE and if required, updated for 2022/23.

3. Training and awareness

In addition to the original DPE e-learning training modules 101/02 staff attended DPE's online GDPR refresh training in September 2022 and many staff have completed a number of additional training modules including: clear desk, data breaches, password security, physical security and working from home.

Where staff have yet to complete a training module, NB is aware of the reporting function within the DPE website to monitor, review and follow up with staff as needed.

The school should continue to raise staff awareness, for example, findings from audit walks can be communicated to staff regarding best practice, and e-learning training can be selected for staff to complete as relevant.

4. Audit walk

An audit walk was completed in the Autumn term 2021 which had a positive outcome. Further walks can be completed by NB and where requested by DPE. Findings can be reported back to staff which will support raising staff awareness. It is recommended that an audit walk is completed termly. The GDPR governor can also be invited on future walks as relevant.

5. Next steps

Challenges with COVID-19 have meant that the school has had to prioritise resources. The school was at an advantage as it was already at an advanced stage with its GDPR compliance programme. Focus and next steps for the school and consultants during visits/remote consultations will be:

- Appoint a GDPR governor.
- Review compliance policy/procedural documentation including information security.
- Ratify the latest DPE GDPR policy and upload to the GDPR section of the school website.
- Ensure all staff have completed GDPR training, including Stay Safe Online Training (cyber security).
- Complete internal audit walks and feed back findings to staff to raise awareness, and improve practice in school. A governor can also be included as appropriate.
- Continue to develop the schools retention schedule and processes for adhering to retention guidelines, and communicate to staff.
- Completion of the record of processing and risk management (DPIAs), including third party suppliers.
- Continue to vet third parties and ensure GDPR compliant contracts are in place.